EXERCISE 1

Direct Integration: General Solutions

Original statement · ProblemsCh2.pdf

Direct integration • Antiderivatives

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Find the general solution to the following equations:

(i) $y'(x) = e^{3x} - x$;
(ii) $x\,y'(x) = 1$;
(iii) $y'(x) = x\,e^{x^2}$;
(iv) $(1+x)\,y'(x) = x$;
(v) $(1+x^2)\,y'(x) = x$.

Source: ProblemsCh2.pdf, Exercise 1 (page 1).

PHASE 1: CLASSIFICATION, HYPOTHESES AND DOMAIN

Each equation is first order, explicit once the coefficient of y' is divided out, and the unknown y does not appear on the right-hand side:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x).$$

- (i) $f(x) = e^{3x} - x$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$.
- (ii) $f(x) = 1/x$, continuous on $(-\infty, 0)$ and on $(0, \infty)$; at $x = 0$ the equation reads $0 = 1$, so no solution can be defined at $x = 0$.
- (iii) $f(x) = xe^{x^2}$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$.
- (iv) $f(x) = x/(1+x)$, continuous on $(-\infty, -1)$ and on $(-1, \infty)$; at $x = -1$ the equation reads $0 = -1$, so no solution can be defined at $x = -1$.
- (v) $f(x) = x/(1+x^2)$, continuous on $\mathbb{R}$ because $1 + x^2 \geq 1 > 0$.

Unknown: a function y differentiable on an interval I on which f is continuous. Because f does not depend on y, the right-hand side is trivially Lipschitz in y and the existence-uniqueness theorem (Robinson, Theorem 6.2) gives exactly one solution for each initial condition $y(x_0) = y_0$ on every such interval.

PHASE 2: CHOICE OF METHOD AND CHANGE OF VARIABLES

Why this method: when $y' = f(x)$ with f continuous on an interval, the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus gives an antiderivative F, and two antiderivatives on an interval differ by a constant (a function with zero derivative on an interval is constant, by the Mean Value Theorem). So direct integration produces all solutions.

Change of variables: none is needed for the equation itself. Where an integral is not immediate, a substitution is written explicitly: $u = 3x$ in (i), $u = x^2$ in (iii), $u = 1 + x^2$ in (v), and a polynomial division (rewriting $x = (1 + x) - 1$) in (iv). Constants of integration are attached separately on each interval of continuity.

$$y(x) = \int f(x)\,dx = F(x) + C.$$

METHOD OF THE CLASS NOTES [NOTES, PP. 2–3]

The class notes integrate a first-order equation from the initial point to the current point and close with Barrow's rule (the population equation, p. 2; Step 2 of the integrating-factor algorithm, p. 3). When the right side does not contain y, $y' = f(x)$ with f continuous on an interval J, pick any $x_0 \in J$:

$$\int_{x_0}^{x} y'(s)\,ds = y(x) - y(x_0) = \int_{x_0}^{x} f(s)\,ds,$$

so the free value $y(x_0)$ is the constant C of the general solution, one for each interval of continuity. In the form (L) of the notes, (ii), (iv) and (v) read $a_0(x)\,y' = b(x)$; dividing by a_0 is allowed only where $a_0 \neq 0$, which is why (ii) and (iv) split into two intervals.

PHASE 3: STEP-BY-STEP DERIVATION

Part (i): $y' = e^{3x} - x$

Integrate term by term:

$$y(x) = \int e^{3x}\,dx - \int x\,dx.$$

For the first integral put $u = 3x$, so $du = 3\,dx$ and $dx = du/3$:

$$\int e^{3x}\,dx = \frac{1}{3}\int e^{u}\,du = \frac{1}{3}e^{u} = \frac{1}{3}e^{3x}.$$

The second integral is $\int x\,dx = x^2/2$. Hence

$$y(x) = \frac{1}{3}e^{3x} - \frac{x^2}{2} + C, \qquad C \in \mathbb{R},\ x \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Part (ii): $x\,y' = 1$

On each interval $x \neq 0$ divide by x to get $y' = 1/x$. Then

$$y(x) = \int \frac{dx}{x} = \ln|x| + C.$$

The absolute value is needed: for $x > 0$, $\frac{d}{dx}\ln x = 1/x$; for $x < 0$, $\frac{d}{dx}\ln(-x) = \frac{-1}{-x} = \frac{1}{x}$. The two half-lines are not connected, so the constants are independent:

$$y(x) = \begin{cases} \ln x + C_1, & x > 0, \\ \ln(-x) + C_2, & x < 0, \end{cases} \qquad C_1, C_2 \in \mathbb{R}.$$

Part (iii): $y' = x e^{x^2}$

Substitute $u = x^2$, so $du = 2x\,dx$ and $x\,dx = du/2$:

$$y(x) = \int x e^{x^2}\,dx = \frac{1}{2}\int e^{u}\,du = \frac{1}{2}e^{u} + C = \frac{1}{2}e^{x^2} + C.$$

Part (iv): $(1 + x)\,y' = x$

On each interval $x \neq -1$ divide by $1 + x$ and rewrite the numerator as $x = (1 + x) - 1$:

$$y'(x) = \frac{x}{1+x} = \frac{(1+x)-1}{1+x} = 1 - \frac{1}{1+x}.$$

Integrate, using $u = 1+x$, $du = dx$ for the second term:

$$y(x) = \int 1\,dx - \int \frac{du}{u} = x - \ln|1+x| + C.$$

Again the constants are independent on $(-\infty, -1)$ and on $(-1, \infty)$:

$$y(x) = x - \ln|1+x| + C_{\pm}.$$

Part (v): $(1+x^2)\,y' = x$

Since $1 + x^2 > 0$ on all of $\mathbb{R}$, divide: $y' = x/(1+x^2)$. Substitute $u = 1+x^2$, so $du = 2x\,dx$ and $x\,dx = du/2$:

$$y(x) = \int \frac{x\,dx}{1+x^2} = \frac{1}{2}\int \frac{du}{u} = \frac{1}{2}\ln|u| + C = \frac{1}{2}\ln(1+x^2) + C.$$

No absolute value is needed because $u = 1 + x^2 > 0$.

PHASE 4: VERIFICATION, LIMITS AND INTERPRETATION

Check each result by differentiating (chain rule written out):

- (i) $\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{3}e^{3x} - \frac{x^2}{2} + C\right] = \frac{1}{3}\cdot 3e^{3x} - x = e^{3x} - x.$
- (ii) $x \cdot \frac{d}{dx}\ln|x| = x \cdot \frac{1}{x} = 1$ for $x \neq 0$.
- (iii) $\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{2}e^{x^2}\right] = \frac{1}{2}e^{x^2}\cdot 2x = xe^{x^2}.$
- (iv) $(1+x)\,\frac{d}{dx}\left[x - \ln|1+x|\right] = (1+x)\left(1 - \frac{1}{1+x}\right) = (1+x) - 1 = x.$
- (v) $(1+x^2)\,\frac{d}{dx}\left[\frac{1}{2}\ln(1+x^2)\right] = (1+x^2)\cdot\frac{1}{2}\cdot\frac{2x}{1+x^2} = x.$

Symbolic check with sympy (dsolve and differentiation of the closed forms) reproduces the five results above.

Domain remarks: the solutions of (i), (iii), (v) are defined on all of $\mathbb{R}$. For (ii) and (iv) the solution cannot be extended through $x = 0$ and $x = -1$ respectively, because the equation itself is inconsistent there ($0 = 1$ and $0 = -1$), and $\ln|x|$, $\ln|1+x|$ are unbounded at those points. The equations in (iv) and (v) look similar but behave differently: only (iv) has a singular point, since $1 + x$ vanishes at $x = -1$ whereas $1 + x^2$ never vanishes.

RESULTS

Part	General solution	Domain
(i)	$y = \frac{1}{3}e^{3x} - \frac{1}{2}x^2 + C$	$\mathbb{R}$
(ii)	$y = \ln\lvert x\rvert + C_{\pm}$	$x \neq 0$
(iii)	$y = \frac{1}{2}e^{x^2} + C$	$\mathbb{R}$
(iv)	$y = x - \ln\lvert 1 + x\rvert + C_{\pm}$	$x \neq -1$
(v)	$y = \frac{1}{2}\ln(1 + x^2) + C$	$\mathbb{R}$